

Fakir Sannyasi Rebellion

The British rule was gruesome. Even, peasants joined in the rebellion against British. One of the most notable rebellions and protests by mendicants was Fakir Sannyasi rebellion (1770-1800 approximately).

Sarker (2017) stated that under Mughal rule, Sannyasis and Fakirs received tax-free lands which established their religious freedom and enriched their integration into the socio-economic state in Bengal, as they used to cultivate in the lands and establish religious establishments. However, after intervention of British East India Company, they were faced with taxation from the Permanent Settlement Act 1793, where the British assigned a Zamindar to land who had to take taxes from them and pay an amount to the British (Dasgupta 1992).

Sinha (2000) stated, British focused on collecting taxes from the peasants of Bengal and thus oppressed Bengal by oppressive agricultural policies. Thus, Muslim and Hindu ascetics took stand against British colonizers and great rebellion took place in Dinajpur.

British attacked by giving prohibition of Sannyasis to pilgrimage and Fakirs from visiting shrines and giving them tax policies which fueled conflict according to Sarker (2017) alongside economic perspective. They used guerilla warfare. To conclude, critical aspect of this rebellion was the notion of anti-colonialism but fueled with anger of religious sentiments and socio-economic perspectives and fighting economic oppression, and this rebellion is thought to have paved the way for unity among different beliefs and illustrated their enemy.

Reference

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Titu Mir Rebellion

Permanent Settlement Law (1793), by Lord Cornwallis, caused peasants to pay huge taxation.

Zamindar were given ownership of land and they had to collect revenue by sunset (Sunset Law). It was a smart move giving Zamindar ownership for revenue and improving agriculture. But the Diwani taxes for land revenue from peasants were harsh. Thus, there were rebellions and one of them was Titu Mir Rebellion (1830-31).

Titu Mir was a preacher and wanted to establish Islamic teachings. Neena and Anandhi (2023) stated Titu Mir was raised from oppressed community and thus protested against dual administration. He was voice of the voiceless peasants. The Titu Mir rebellion was not just about political rights but for protecting the motherland (Neena and Anandhi, 2023). His objective was filled with Islamic teachings and had anti-British and anti-Zamindar agendas risen from being rebellious.

He made bamboo stockade and attacked from there by guerilla warfare. He and 300 people were killed brutally.

In the novel of Mahasweta Devi (2000) told us about the struggles of ordinary people. Researchers think Titu Mir as a resemblance of justice and protest against injustice of the society, even today, people admire him as a symbol of resistance and anti-colonial leader.

Reference

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Faraizi Movement

The Faraizi movement was led by Haji Shariatullah from 1804-1857. He was a pious man and lived in Arabia to study Islamic jurisprudence, and Sufism. He came back to Bengal with the mission to teach people about Islamic values and stop the superstitions of the religion of that area (Iqbal, 2011).

Iqbal (2011) stated Shariatullah aimed to transform the socio-economy situation of Bengal and free peasants from the oppression of the British and resist the exploitative policies of the revenue system. Mallick (1961) and Chattopadhyay (1990) argues that social oppression acted as a catalyst for the rebellion with spreading the teachings of Islam to peasants. In short, he aimed to cleanse the society from the local custom with superstition but also free the peasants from the British colonialism (Khan, 1965).

Iqbal (2011) points out that the importance of the movement was that it made the socio-political structure of the society a radical change. We saw how peasants struggled and the colonial regime opened the path of religious reformation and social change against the oppressive community. There were revolts from 1838-1847. Even, after his death, Dudu Miyan his son took his place the leader. His movement influenced indigo rebellion and Muslim uprising movements, as a cornerstone of anti-colonialism.

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Indian National Congress

Founded in 1885 by Sir Allan Octavian Hume, it was one of the notable intellectual protests by the educated Indian leaders. Upper caste Hindus were awakening to the political ideologies and question administration of the British rulers. The access of Western education gave them political enlightenment but it excluded Muslims and low-caste Hindus. So, British rulers created an official ground for the Indians to share and solve their issues.

Hume (1911) stated Upper-caste Indians were given an opportunity to have a place to present their grievances and aimed for having more privilege under British rule and their basic rights. Education was a huge aspect as Western education was secular, liberal and open-minded, thus enabling Indians to ponder upon their regime (Shah, 2010). It established a sense of unity and served as an anti-colonial grievance.

Shah (2010) criticized that INC served for elite Indian class, the Muslims were still unheard and the administrative ways of the British were not suitable for the Indian diverse societies. Hume (1911) stated that British introduced Indian Councils Act of 1909, acting as political recognition for Hindus, so it ignited Muslims for their political recognition which was known as All India Muslim League. It was a great organization which initiated the political identity of Indian Hindus and later the Muslims too.

Reference

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All-India Muslim League

After Indian National Congress which Muslims were not included, emerged All-India Muslim league as a response for that. British convinced Sir Khwaja Salimullah for this organization and gave positions to elite Muslim class. Also, Muslim leaders thought that they were lacking acknowledgement and wanted to safeguard the political rights and interests (Malik, 2012).

The organization aimed at protecting Muslim political rights. It started as a counter for Indian National Congress. INC was organization for elite Hindu class, which was not really concerned about the rights of Muslims, so they had to safeguard their interest and rights. According to Rahimullah (1913), AIMC created an Islamic identity for the Muslims living in India and made a cultural likeness.

The organization was a safeguard for Indian Muslims to their Islamic and cultural identity. It was the foundation for eventual creation of Pakistan in 1947 achieving the political and cultural rights of Islamic regime (Rahimullah, 1913; Malik, 2012). Experts say that ALML became the central political party and even after the partition 1947, it had the pivotal role for Muslims' political interest.

Reference

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